

SECURITY WATCH

DDoS attacks double compared to last year

As per Kaspersky, a recent study revealed that the number of DDoS attacks in Q4 2019 has almost doubled in comparison to the corresponding number in Q4 2018. Kaspersky DDoS Protection detected 44 per cent higher attacks in Q4 2019 as compared to Q4 2018. Delving further into botnet activity revealed that around 28 per cent of these attacks took place on weekends. Several large-scale DDoS attacks were against financial institutions in South Africa, Singapore and a number of Scandinavian countries. Some of these attacks were directly targeted towards the Labour party in the UK to upset its digital systems. A few others were against the Minecraft servers set up in the Vatican. This reiterates that DDoS attacks are still common amongst cybercriminals. The rise in DDoS attacks during the fourth quarter could be due to the hike in online business and retail activity during the holiday season.

MOBILE WATCH

iQOO 3

iQOO has arrived to make its mark in the highly-competitive smartphone market with the iQOO 3 on February 25. The smartphone is available in both 4G and 5G variants. Powered by the Qualcomm Snapdragon 865 SoC, the iQOO 3 sports pressure-sensitive buttons on the side frames for an enhanced gaming experience. The phone features 12GB LPDDR5 RAM and up to 256GB internal storage. It sports a Full HD+ AMOLED display with a 90Hz refresh rate. It also has an in-display fingerprint sensor as well as a massive 4,440mAh battery. The phone can also support fast charging of up to 55W! Coming to the cameras, the 5G variant features a 48MP primary lens, a 13MP telephoto lens and another 13MP wide angle shooter. The front camera is a 16MP sensor. The prices of these devices were recently announced, the 5G variant costs ₹44,990 while the 4G one starts at ₹36,990.



APP WATCH

Typewise Keyboard



The customary QWERTY keypad has certainly stood the test of time on our smartphones. Granted there have been plenty of nifty additions to this keyboard such as swipe-typing, word-prediction, auto-correct, GIFs, emojis and more, however, we've never really seen the standard keyboard on phones being reinvented to a substantial degree. In comes Typewise. After a successful soft launch in Switzerland, Typewise Keyboard has now been released on the Play Store around the

world on Android. The keyboard ditches the familiar keyboard layout and button shapes and overhauls it with hexagonal tiles/buttons instead. It's no question that this new design will take users a fair amount of time to get used to, but the company claims that this new way of typing can eliminate up to a whopping 80 per cent typos. To ease new users into this convoluted learning process, the app developers have included an in-depth tutorial to teach users the new keyboard functions.

New features and actions are abundant in Typewise Keyboard. Swiping up will capitalise letters, swiping left on the keyboard will delete text whereas

swiping right will restore it. Like other keyboards, Typewise can also learn users' habits which will enable it to predict words, correct them and add new words

to the vocabulary. The company also claims that its AI engine can run offline as well, aiding in privacy. Also, the keyboard doesn't require any permissions to run. The keyboard is free to install,

however, there is a Pro version which allows users to access other themes and features such as vibration, text replacements and more. So, if you are looking for a break from your traditional keyboard, you can give Typewise a go. Who knows? It may actually take you by surprise and become your daily driver.



Drive Password



Drive Password is an advanced password manager that stores your passwords onto Google

Drive. All password data is encrypted and you can also set access, so you can allow certain users to view a particular password as well.

DoubleTake by FiLMiC Pro



This app essentially makes use of multiple cameras by allowing you to film videos using two cameras

simultaneously. You can pick and choose combinations such as wide and telephoto, primary lens and selfie lens, and more.

Activity Bubbles



This is another Digital Wellbeing app by Google which shows users their phone usage in the form of a live wallpaper of bubbles. Each unlock creates a new bubble and the longer you stay on your phone, the larger it grows.